

Where we are, and what's next.

Where we are now (done)

- **Working, investor-ready demo** (live: seymurhh.github.io/forkcast-live) — accounts, onboarding, BMI/TDEE/macros, Fit-Score discovery + map, dashboard, photo logging.
- **Strategy package** — business plan, financial model, system architecture, research dossier (private).
- **Private source repo + one-command deploy.**

What we do **not** have yet: real users, real restaurants, a pitch deck distributed, or external validation. That's the gap the next steps close.

The next step — single focus for ~4 weeks

Turn the demo into proof. Get evidence diners want this and restaurants will play — before writing more code or raising.

- **20 user interviews** (Boston/Cambridge, Harvard network first) → one-page “what we heard.”
- **Demand signal:** add a real **waitlist** to the live site; drive ~200 signups via TikTok/IG + campus channels.
- **5–10 restaurant conversations** in one dense neighborhood → ≥3 verbal “I’d try it.”
- Build the **pitch deck** (10–13 slides) from the business plan. **drafted**

Then — next ~90 days (in order)

- **Beachhead data layer** — real chain nutrition (USDA + Nutritionix) for ~50 real Boston restaurants.
- **MVP backend** — real auth + database; turn on real Claude photo analysis (SSR host).
- **First 10 restaurants + 100 active users** in one neighborhood; track **D30 retention (>35%)** and **CAC**.
- **Apply for non-dilutive grants** — NIH/NIDDK & USDA-NIFA SBIR (verify post-Apr-2026 solicitation dates).

Funding track (in parallel)

- **Now:** deck + clean data room (docs we have).
- **Month 1–2:** warm pre-seed intros (health-/food-tech, Harvard/MIT); apply to an accelerator.

- **Target:** ~\$1.0–1.5M pre-seed SAFE, gated on validation + SBIR top-up.

Numbers that unlock the raise

METRIC	TARGET
D30 retention	> 35%
Featured / committed restaurants	10+ live · 150+ pipeline
Active users (1 metro)	100 → 1,000
LTV : CAC	≥ 3:1 · payback 6–9 mo

Housekeeping (this week)

- Decide on the public deploy repo (delete + recreate for a 100%-clean history, or keep scrubbed version).
- Trademark-check “Forkcast”; buy a domain (e.g. forkcast.app) and point the live site at it.
- Recruit 1–2 advisors: a registered dietitian and a fast-casual operator.

One line: the product is built — the next job is **validation + a deck + first restaurants**, not more features.